

## Chapter 3

# Managing Projects and Project Libraries

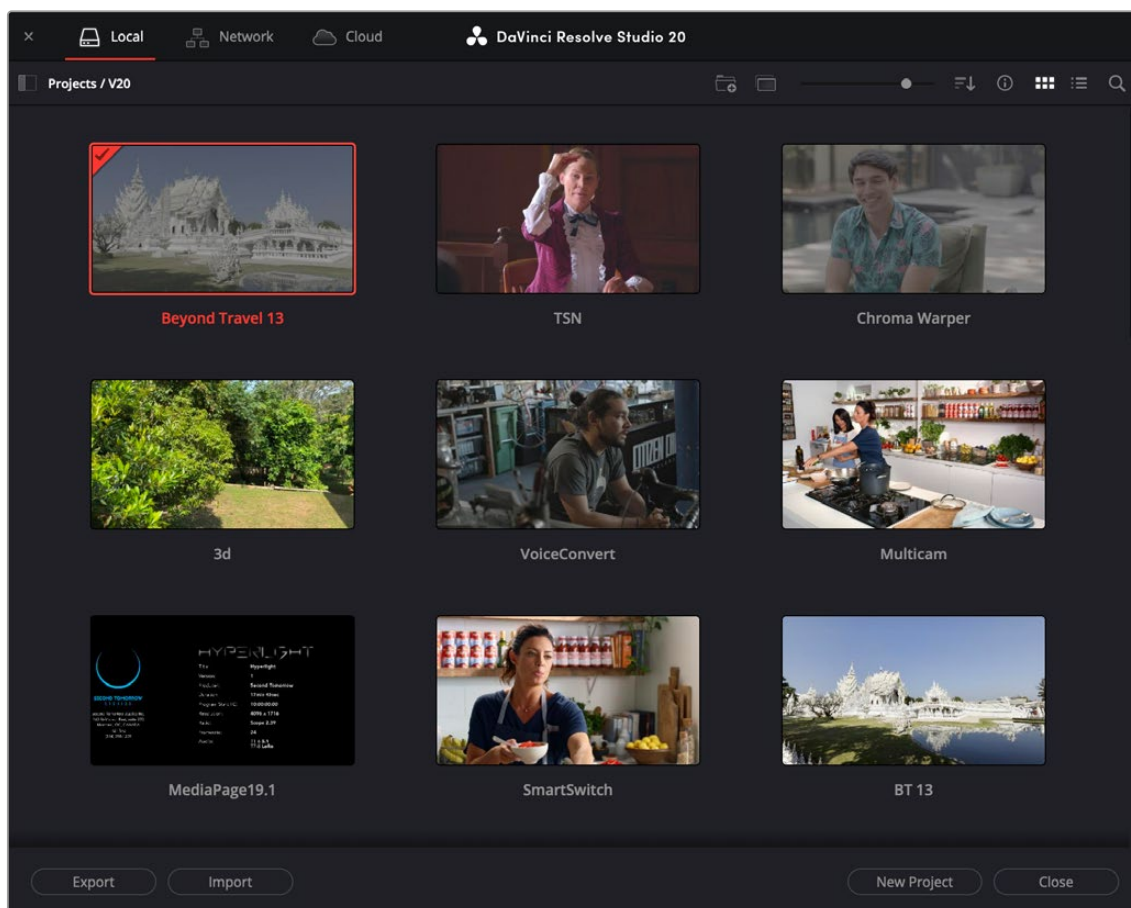
This chapter covers how to use the Project Manager to organize the projects you're working on in DaVinci Resolve, as well as how to deal with managing the project libraries that serve as the organizational foundation of the Project Manager. You'll also see how to export and import projects, and how to archive a project and its media for long-term storage.

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# Using the Project Manager

Ordinarily, the Project Manager is the first window you'll see when DaVinci Resolve starts up. It's a convenient, centralized browser for creating, organizing, and managing all of your projects. Unlike other applications that rely on your file manager for organizing projects, DaVinci Resolve requires you to do most project organization in the Project Manager.



Project Manager

If you've already opened a project, you can reopen the Project Manager at any time by clicking the Home button at the bottom right-hand corner of the DaVinci Resolve window, in the Page Navigation bar. If you've hidden the Page Navigation bar at the bottom of the DaVinci Resolve window, you can open the Project Manager by choosing File > Project Manager.



The Project Manager button at the bottom-right corner of the DaVinci Resolve interface

## Launching DaVinci Resolve for the First Time?

If you've just installed DaVinci Resolve and have opened it for the first time, it's time to set the preferences in order to specify your language, scratch disk volume, and hardware configuration for video and audio I/O and control panels (if you have one).

For more information about setting the preferences in DaVinci Resolve, see *Chapter 4, "System and User Preferences."*

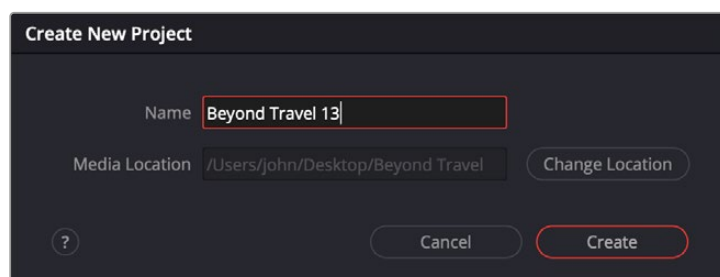
## Creating a New Project

The first step into DaVinci Resolve is to create a new Project in the Project Manager, which is conveniently the first thing that opens when you launch the program. Each project contains links to all of the media, graphics, and sound files used in your film, as well as timelines where all the editing, color correction, motion graphics, and audio post work is done.

There are several settings, options, and preferences attached to each project (you can access them by clicking on the small gear icon in the very bottom right of the interface), and all of them are described in detail later in this section. However, actually creating a project requires only four steps.

### Creating a New Project:

- 1 Click on the New Project button at the bottom of the Project Manager.
- 2 Type in a name for your project.
- 3 Observe the folder where any media created by DaVinci Resolve will be stored in Media Location. Make sure you have some space on this drive. Clicking on the Change Location button lets you select another drive/folder instead of the default.
- 4 Click the Create button.



The Create New Project dialog

## Project Management

The Project Manager provides an in-application interface for creating, renaming, and deleting projects. Many of these commands exist within the contextual menu that appears when you right-click the background of the Project Manager.

### Methods of project management:

- **To create a new project:** Double-click the Default Project icon, or click the New Project button at the bottom of the window. A new project is created, and DaVinci Resolve opens up the Media page. Once a project is open, you can alter its project settings by clicking the gear icon.
- **To open a previously saved project:** Double-click any Project icon, or Item if you're in List view. You can also select a project and click the Open button.

- **To open a project in Read-Only Mode:** Right-click a Project icon or Item, and choose Open in Read Only Mode. This lets you open a project without danger of altering it. If you make changes, you can use the Save As command to save a new copy of the project with a new name.
- **To rename a project:** Right-click a Project icon or Item, choose Rename, and type a new name in the dialog that appears, clicking OK when you're finished.
- **To load project settings from another project to the currently open project:** Right-click a Project icon or Item (other than the currently open project), and choose "Load Project Settings to Current Project." This lets you change a project's settings prior to opening it in cases where the project settings are causing some kind of problem that prevents you from opening the project.
- **To update the thumbnails of a project in the Project Manager:** Right-click any project, and choose "Update Thumbnails."
- **To delete a project:** Select one or more projects, then either press the Backspace key, or right-click one of the selected projects and choose Delete. Click OK when a dialog asks you to confirm the operation.

**NOTE:** You cannot move or delete the currently open or loaded project.

## Importing and Exporting DaVinci Resolve Projects (.drp Files)

DaVinci Resolve projects are saved with the file extension .drp and enable you to exchange files with other DaVinci Resolve users. If you double-click a DaVinci Resolve .drp file in the Windows or macOS file system, this will automatically open DaVinci Resolve, import that project into the Project Manager regardless of what kind of project library you're using, and open that project so that you're ready to work.

### Importing and Exporting Projects in Local Project Libraries

If you're using local project libraries to manage your projects, you can copy and import projects using the project folders in the file manager of either macOS or Windows. This method does not work for DaVinci Resolve on Linux.

#### Moving projects from one local project library into another using macOS or Windows:

- 1 Locate the local project library directory in which the project you want to copy is stored. If you don't know where the designated local project library directory is, you can open DaVinci Resolve and check the directory path for the current local project library in the Project Libraries sidebar.
- 2 Copy the project folder from the source workstation to the designated local project library directory on the destination workstation. If you don't know where the designated local project library directory is, you can open DaVinci Resolve on the workstation you're copying the project to and check the directory path for the current local project library in the Project Libraries sidebar.
- 3 Once you've copied the project folder into the correct location, you'll need to quit and reopen DaVinci Resolve. Afterwards, the imported project should appear in the Project Manager.

### Importing and Exporting Projects in Network Project Libraries

If you're using a network project library, another set of commands let you import and export projects using the .drp file format. You can also export .drp files from local project libraries if you want to export a more self-contained item to transport.

**To import a .drp project file, do one of the following:**

- Select the Import button at the bottom of the Project Manager, then find and select a .drp project file using the Import Project File dialog, and click Open.
- Drag the .drp file you want to import from your file system and drop it anywhere into the Project Manager window.
- Right-click any empty area of the Project Manager and choose Import, then find and select a .drp project file using the Import Project File dialog, and click Open.

**To import a .drp project file and reconfigure the gallery path at the same time:**

- Hold the Option key down while right-clicking any empty area of the Project Manager, and choose Import+, then find and select a .drp project file, and click Open. Upon opening, the gallery path will automatically be updated to that of your workstation.

**To export the currently open project as a .drp file:**

- Choose File > Export Project, and when the Save dialog appears, choose a location, enter a name, and click Save. The result is a self-contained file with a .drp file suffix saved at the location you chose.

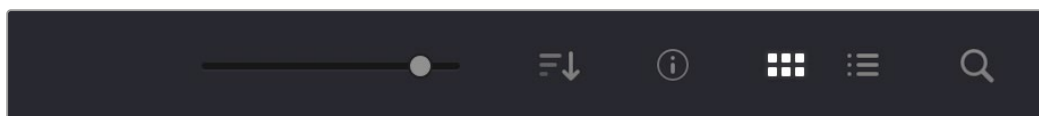
**To export a .drp project file from the Project Manager:**

- Select the Export button at the bottom of the Project Manager, and when the Save dialog appears, choose a location, enter a name, and click Save. The result is a self-contained file with a .drp file suffix saved at the location you chose.
- Right-click a Project icon or Item in the Project Manager, then choose one of the following commands;
  - **Export Project:** Exports project data with no LUTs and no stills. Best when you need to export the smallest possible file.
  - **Export Project With Stills and LUTs:** Exports the project, including both still frames in the Gallery and LUTs used in grades. Best when you want to export the most self-contained file and you can't guarantee the recipient will have the same LUTs you do.
- When the Save dialog appears, choose a location, enter a name, and click Save. The result is a self-contained file with a .drp file suffix saved at the location you chose.

**TIP:** You can export multiple projects from the Project Manager at the same time by either command-clicking or lassoing the projects, right-clicking on one of them, and selecting Export Projects from the drop-down menu. All projects will be saved in the same location.

## Project Manager View Options

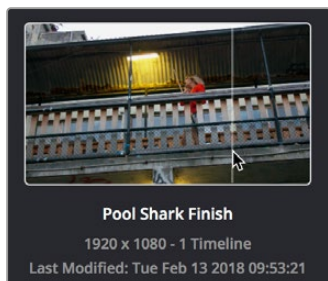
Four buttons at the top right let you control how projects are viewed in the Project Manager.



Select Thumbnail or List View

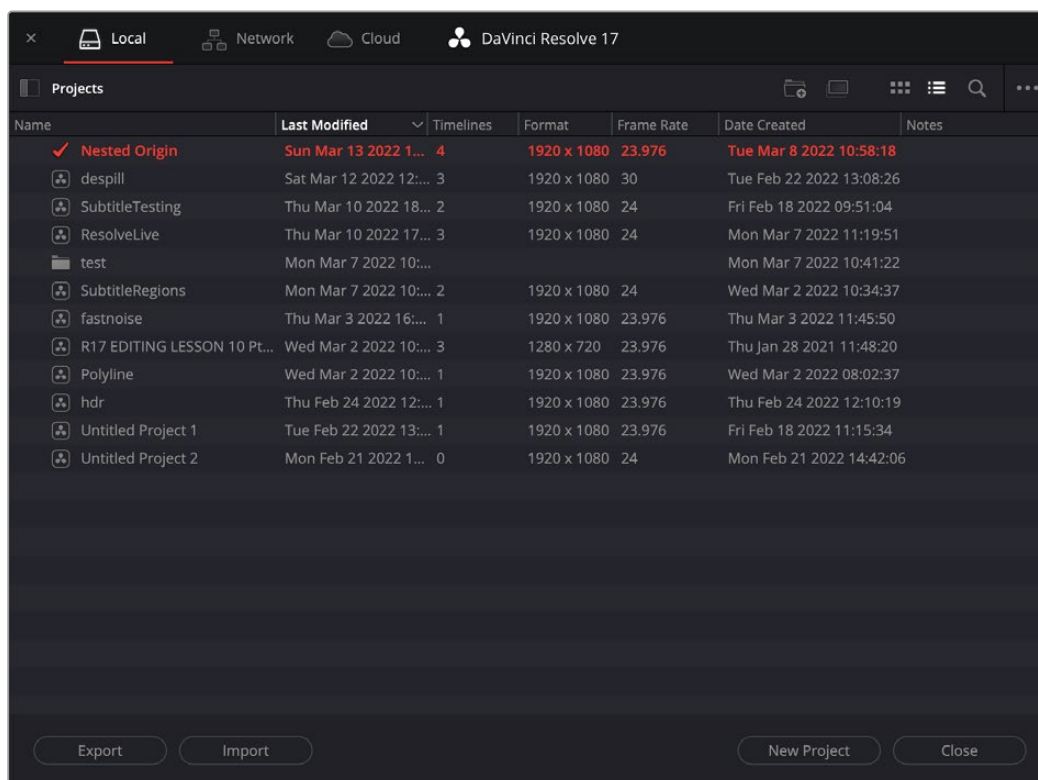
- **Zoom slider:** (Only appears in Thumbnail view) Lets you adjust the size of the thumbnails in Thumbnail view.
- **Project Sort Order drop-down:** (Only appears in Thumbnail view) Lets you choose the sort order of projects in Thumbnail view.

- **Information:** (Only appears in Thumbnail view) Lets you show or hide additional project information displayed underneath each project's thumbnail, including the frame size, number of timelines within, and when that project was last modified.
- **Thumbnail view:** Each project is represented by a large image that can be hover-scrubbed to reveal five representative images from that project.



Hover-scrub over Project icon;  
information is enabled

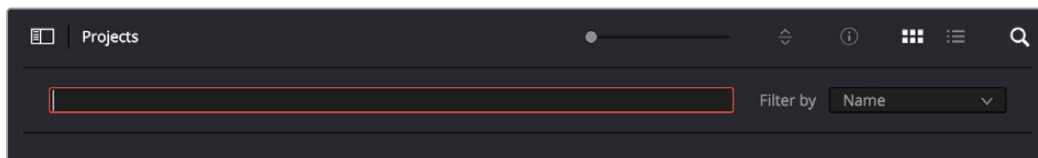
- **List view:** Every project appears as an item in a list that has seven columns: Name, Last Modified, Timelines, Format, Frame Rate, Date Created, and Note. You can click any column header to sort the contents of the Project Manager by that criteria; clicking the header a second time toggles that column between ascending and descending sorting.



Project List view

## Searching for Projects

Clicking the magnifying glass button at the upper right-hand corner of the Project Manager exposes the Search Options, which can be used to locate one or more projects based on the metadata that's selected in the Filter By drop-down menu to the right of it.

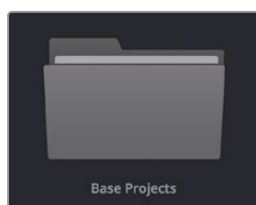


Search field open with Filter by search criteria selected

Using the drop-down menu, you can choose to search by name, or by project format. Once you've chosen a criteria, begin typing into the search field, and the Project Manager will immediately and dynamically begin to be filtered by your search text.

## Organizing Projects in Folders

If you're organizing a lot of projects, you can create folders to put them into.



A folder in the Project Manager

### Methods of working with project folders:

- **To create a folder:** Click the New Folder button, then enter a name into the Create New Folder dialog and click Create.
- **To delete a folder:** Right-click a folder, choose Delete, and click Yes when prompted. All projects inside a deleted folder will be deleted as well.
- **To rename a folder:** Right-click a folder, choose Rename, then enter a new name and click OK.
- **To copy a folder:** Right-click on a folder and choose Copy from the drop-down menu, or select the folder and press Command-C. Any projects enclosed inside that folder will also be copied.
- **To paste a folder:** Once a copy operation has been made, right-click on the background of the Project Manager and choose Paste from the drop-down menu, or press Command-V. You can paste into other project libraries, into other folders, or into the same location where a new version of the folder will have the word (Copy) appended to it. All enclosed timelines will copy over as well.
- **To open a folder:** Double-click a folder to open it and view its contents. At the upper left-hand corner of the Project Manager, a folder path view shows you which folder is open, as well as where you are within a nested series of folders if that's what you've set up.
- **To exit a folder:** Use the path control at the top of the Project Manager to click on a higher level in the folder hierarchy.
- **To move a project into a folder:** Drag the project onto a folder icon, and drop it to place it inside the folder.
- **To move a project out of a folder:** Open a folder, select one or more projects you want to move, then right-click the selection and choose Cut from the contextual menu. Then, navigate to the next place in the Project manager where you want to place the cut projects, right-click the background of the Project Manager, and choose Paste. The projects should appear in the new location.

# Managing Project Libraries

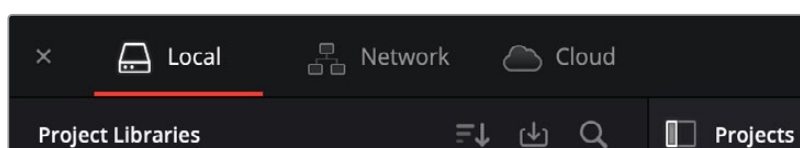
Unlike other applications which save self-contained project files to user-specified locations wherever you like in your file system, DaVinci Resolve takes a more centrally organized approach to project management, using project libraries. By default, DaVinci Resolve uses a local project library to keep track of every project you create. The Project Libraries sidebar lets you manage the projects found within this project library, which are saved to a specific directory on your system (particular to that project library). The default location of this local project library depends on the operating system you use.

However, you can create additional project libraries with which to store other projects, if you like. For example, you might create one project library each for each year in which you work. If you work on series television, you could create multiple project libraries for each program you work on. Or, you could create separate project libraries for each client you do work for. There's no hard and fast rule; ultimately how you use project libraries is entirely up to you and your individual organizational preferences.

## Project Library Types

Project libraries can be stored in three different project library types which work similarly in function but have additional connectivity and sharing features based on your networking setup. You select the Library Type at the top left of the Project Manager.

- **Local:** Stores your project libraries locally on your workstation. This is the default and is best for individual users or single systems.
- **Network:** Stores your project libraries on an external computer that is connected to several workstations on the same local network. It also allows you to control user access to the project library. This is best for a facility composed of multiple workstations in the same building working on the same material.
- **Cloud:** Stores your project libraries in the Blackmagic Cloud. This allows several workstations to connect to the same project library over the internet. It also allows you to control user access to the project library. This is best for multiple people working on the same project from different locations around the world.



The three types of project libraries: local, network, and cloud.

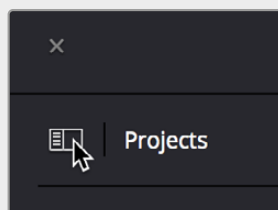
For more information about setting up and configuring the different project library types, see *Chapter 196, "Managing Project Libraries and Project Servers."*



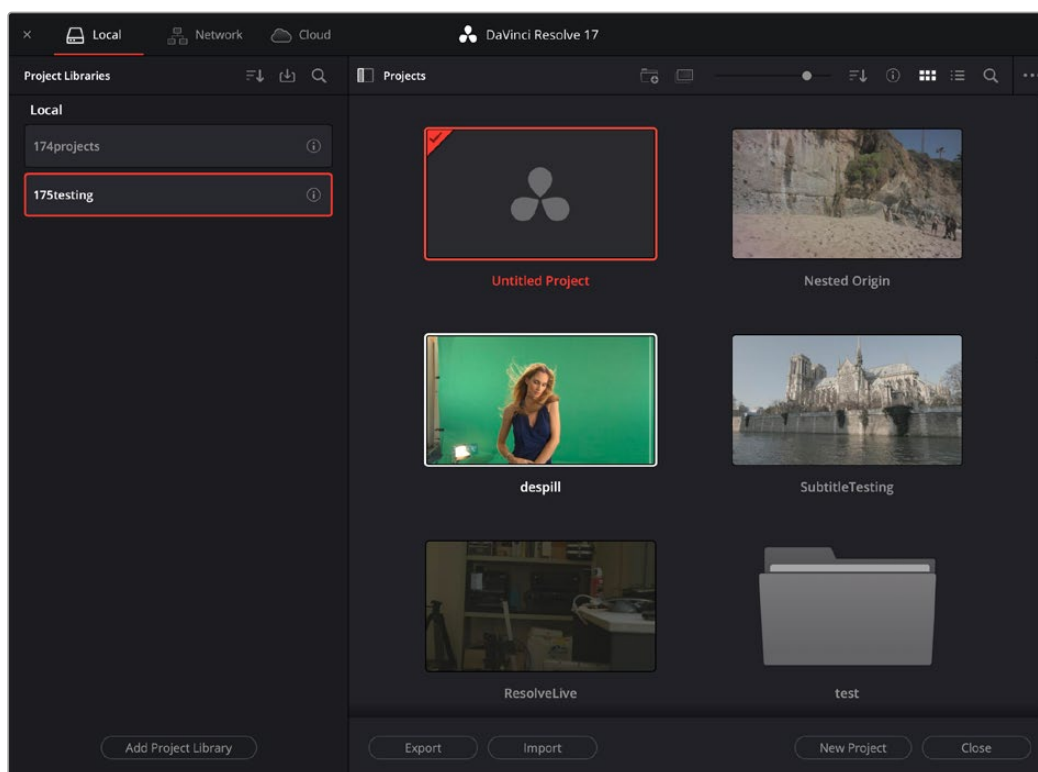
## Opening the Project Libraries Sidebar

If you already have multiple project libraries, then clicking the button at the upper-left hand corner of the Projects Browser reveals a sidebar at the left of the Project Manager that lists every project library on your workstation, with various options for managing these project libraries and for browsing the projects found within them.

You can use this sidebar to open different project libraries and browse the projects found inside.



Project Libraries sidebar button



Project Manager with the Project Libraries sidebar displayed

## Moving Projects From One Project Library to Another on the Same Workstation

If you've used multiple project libraries to organize your projects, you can browse the contents of each project library to search for what you're looking for, and then copy one or more projects from one project library to another if you need to rearrange how they're organized.

**To view the contents of a project library:**

- 1 Click the button at the upper-left hand corner of the Projects window to open the Project Libraries sidebar.
- 2 Click to select a project library in the sidebar, and an orange highlight will appear

If you had a project already open, you'll be asked if you want to save it before closing, because all open projects must be closed prior to viewing the contents of another project library. Then, the projects corresponding to that user within the selected project library appear in the Project Manager window.

**To import a project from another project library using the Project Libraries sidebar:**

- 1 Click the button at the upper-left hand corner of the Projects window to open the Project Libraries sidebar.
- 2 Click to select a project library in the sidebar, and if necessary use the drop-down menu at the right of the project library listing to choose a specific user. The projects corresponding to that user within the selected project library appear in the Project Manager window.
- 3 Select a project you want to import, and press Command-C to copy it.
- 4 Click to select the current project library again (the project library you want to work within).
- 5 Press Command-V to paste the project you copied. A copy appears in the current project library.

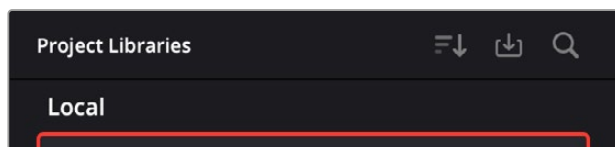
For more details on shared project library setup and operation, see *Chapter 196, "Managing Project Libraries and Project Servers."*

**To import Project Settings from another project using the Project Libraries sidebar:**

- 1 Click the button at the upper-left hand corner of the Projects window to open the Project Libraries sidebar.
- 2 Select a project you want to import Project Settings to so that it's highlighted.
- 3 Right-click any project and choose "Load Project Settings to Current Project." That project's settings will be copied to the project you selected in step 2.

## Managing Project Libraries in the Project Libraries Sidebar

Controls within the Project Libraries sidebar make it easy to create new project libraries (via the button at the bottom), upgrade project libraries that have been flagged (via circular badges), import and export project libraries (via buttons at the top), and reveal additional information about each project library (via buttons at the top of this sidebar).



Project Libraries sidebar controls

**The three controls at the top of the Project Libraries sidebar have the following functions:**

- **Sort Order drop-down menu:** This menu lets you choose how to sort the various local and network project libraries displayed in the sidebar. You can sort by Project Library Name, Schema (by date), Status, or Location in Ascending or Descending order.

- **Restore:** Imports .resolve.backup files to restore a backed up project library.
- **Show Search Field:** Displays a search field and search criteria drop-down that lets you search for project libraries in the sidebar by Name, Schema, Status, or Location.

Clicking on the Display Project Library Details icon (the circled letter “i” to the right of the project library), shows additional information underneath each project library in the sidebar. What information depends on the type of project library. Local project libraries display their status (compatible/incompatible) and location (directory path). Network and cloud project libraries display their schema (created and modified dates), their status (compatible/incompatible), their IP location, and below any members that have access to the project library.

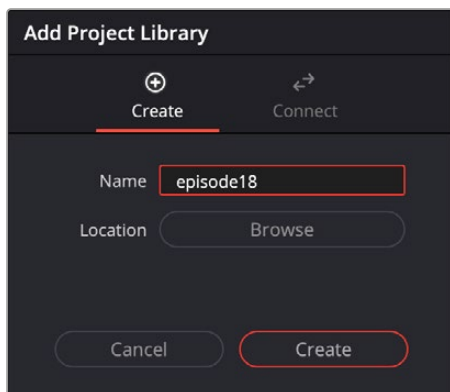
## Creating and Connecting to Project Libraries

You can use local, network, and cloud libraries side by side for switching to the use of one or the other, depending on your needs. These instructions will show you how to set up local project libraries. Network and cloud libraries require additional configuration and setup first.

For more details on network and cloud project libraries setup and operation, see *Chapter 196, “Managing Project Libraries and Project Servers.”*

### To create a new local project library:

- 1 Click the button at the upper-left hand corner of the Projects window to open the Project Libraries sidebar.
- 2 Click the Add Project Library button at the bottom of the sidebar.
- 3 Click on the Create tab. The Add Project Library window should look like the following screenshot:

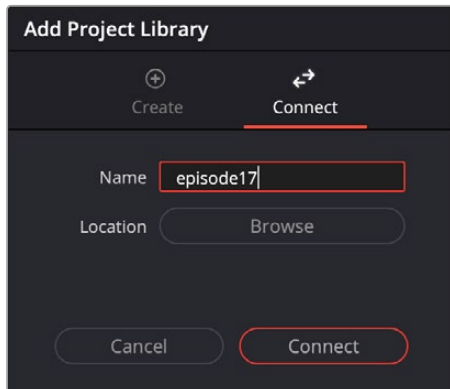


Creating a local project library

- 4 In the remaining fields, do the following:
  - a) Type a name for the new project library into the Name field
  - b) Click within the Location field and use the Filesystem navigation dialog to choose where to put the directory that will contain all of the DaVinci Resolve project directories
- 5 Click Create, and the new local project library will appear in the local project library section of the Project Libraries sidebar.

### To connect to an existing local project library:

- 1 Click the button at the upper-left hand corner of the Projects window to open the Project Libraries sidebar.
- 2 Click the Add Project Library button at the bottom of the sidebar.
- 3 Click on the Connect tab. The Add Project Library window should look like the following screenshot:



Connecting to an existing local project library

- 4 In the remaining fields, do the following:
  - a) Type a name for the new project library into the Name field.
  - b) Click within the Location field and use the Filesystem navigation dialog to choose the location of the existing project library you wish to connect to.
- 5 Click Connect, and the new local project library will appear in the local project library section of the Project Libraries sidebar.

## Duplicating Project Libraries

Local Project Libraries can be duplicated in the same database for backup or iteration purposes.

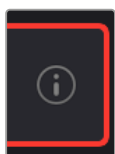
- 1 Right-click on the Library, and select Duplicate from the drop-down menu.
- 2 Select the Resolve Database folder in the file system browser. This can either be the same one you use for the original project or a new one.
- 3 Click on the Open button.
- 4 Rename the new Library in the Clone Library dialog.

## Backing Up and Restoring Project Libraries

You can also back up project libraries by exporting them, and then reimport them later.

### To backup/export a project library:

- 1 Click the button at the upper-left hand corner of the Projects window to open the Project Libraries sidebar.
- 2 Select the project library you want to back up.
- 3 Click the Display Project Library Details icon (the circled letter “i” to the right of the project library).



The Display Project Library Details icon

- 4 Select the Back Up button.
- 5 Choose a location to which to save the backup in the Backup Project Libraries dialog, and click Save.

#### To import a project library:

- 1 Click the button at the upper-left hand corner of the Projects window to open the Project Libraries sidebar.
- 2 Click the Restore button at the top of the Project Libraries sidebar.

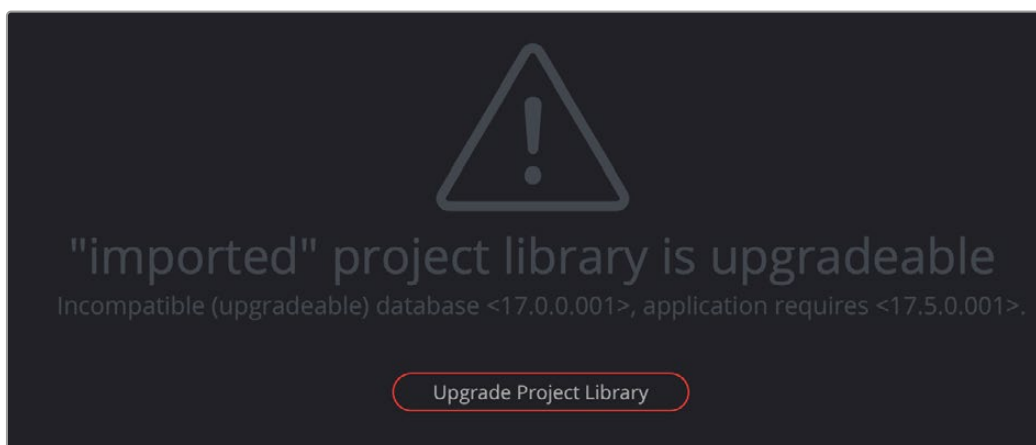


The Restore button

- 3 Find the project library you need to import using the file import dialog, and click Open.
- 4 In the Add Project Library dialog, do the following:
  - a) Type a name for the new project library into the Name field. This will rename the imported project library but will not alter its contents. You can also name it the same as the original project library.
  - b) Click within the Location field and use the Filesystem navigation dialog to choose the directory that contains the existing DaVinci Resolve project libraries.
- 5 Click Create, and the imported local project library will appear in the Local section of the Project Libraries sidebar.

## Upgrading Project Libraries

Selected libraries display an upgrade warning in the Project Manager only when you've installed a new version of DaVinci Resolve and you have project libraries that were created in older versions of DaVinci Resolve that need upgrading.



The upgrade warning in the Project Manager indicates that the project library needs to be upgraded

It's generally a good idea to back up a project library prior to upgrading it, in case something goes wrong. In general, upgrading from a whole version release to the next whole version release of DaVinci Resolve usually requires an upgrade, while upgrading to a dot release of the same version may or may not. If the currently used project library requires an update, you'll be told on application startup.

### To upgrade a project library from an old version of DaVinci Resolve:

Click on a project library that needs updating, and select the Upgrade Project Library button. A dialog appears to confirm if you really want to upgrade that project library. Click Upgrade to proceed.

### Disconnecting and Deleting Project Libraries

You cannot actually delete project libraries in DaVinci Resolve; you can only disconnect them so they don't appear in the Project Library list. However, disconnected project libraries can still be reconnected if you remember their name. The only way to completely delete a project library entry in PostgreSQL is to do so from the command line, or to use the PGAdmin III application that accompanies the PostgreSQL installation that's part of the DaVinci Resolve installation process.

### To disconnect a project library you no longer need:

- Right-click a project library that is not currently selected, and choose Remove from the contextual menu. A dialog appears to confirm if you really want to disconnect that project library. Click Disconnect to proceed.

### Locating Local Project Library Directories in Your File System

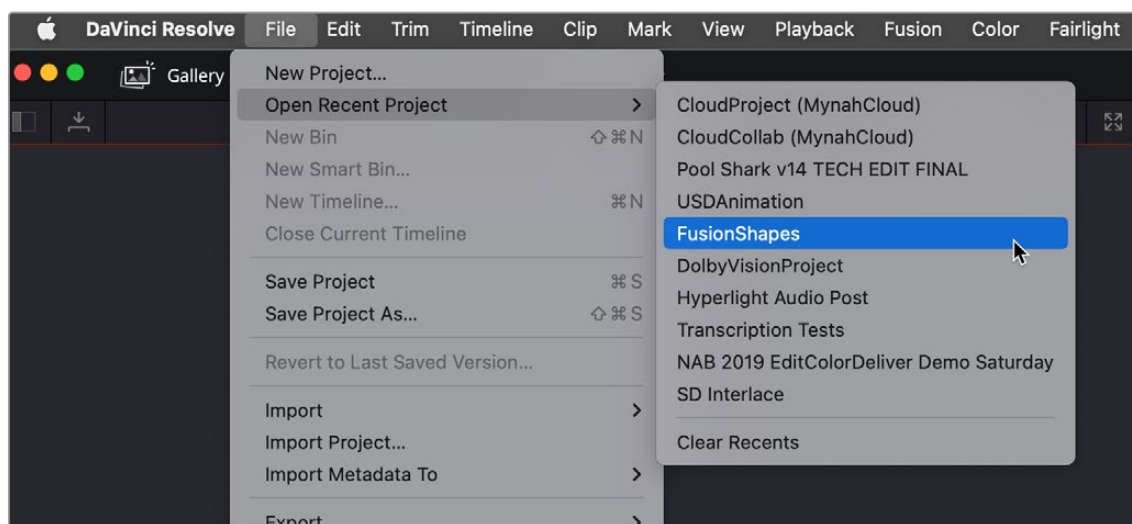
Because local project libraries have a link to a specific directory in your file system, there's a way of locating that directory.

### To locate a project library on your system:

- Right-click any local project library, and choose "Reveal in Finder." A file system window opens up showing you the location of that local project library, inside which are all of its projects.

## Quick Access to Recent Projects from the File Menu

You can open recent projects directly from the File > Open Recent Project menu, rather than having to go to the Project Manager and find it manually.



Opening a recent project from the File menu

# Saving Projects

Once you've created and opened a project, you want to make sure that you regularly save your work.

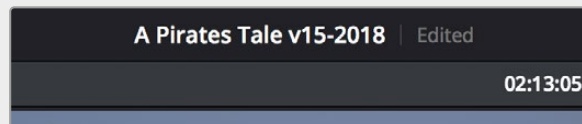
## Methods of saving projects:

- Choose File > Save Project (Command-S).
- To save the current state of your project as a copy with a new name, choose File > Save Project As (Command-Shift-S), then enter a name into the Save Current Project window and click Save.

## To revert to the last saved state of a project:

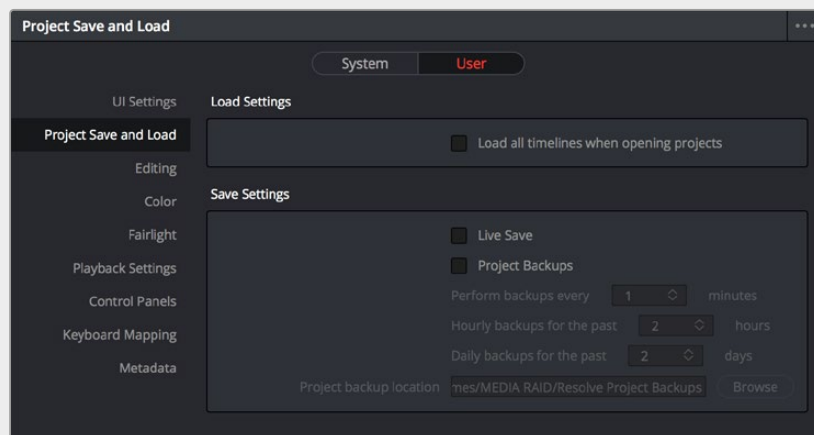
- To save the current state of your project as a copy with a new name, choose File > Save Project As (Command-Shift-S), then enter a name into the Save Current Project window and click Save. If you chose to save as the same name as an existing project, a dialog box will appear allowing you to confirm if you want to overwrite the existing project or to cancel out and choose another name.

As you work on your project, the word “Edited” appears to the right of the project name at the top of the DaVinci Resolve UI to let you know that you have unsaved changes. If you don't save in over 15 minutes, the word “Edited” turns yellow, and if you still don't save in over 30 minutes, it turns red to let you know that you probably should save. If you move the pointer over the word “Edited,” a tooltip appears letting you know when the last save was performed.



The word “Edited” to the right of the project name lets you know you have unsaved changes

DaVinci Resolve also has two auto save mechanisms that you can enable in the Save Settings group of controls, called Live Save and Project Backups.



Auto Save controls in the User Preferences

## Live Save

Enabling Live Save sets DaVinci Resolve to incrementally save changes as you make changes to your project, with no user intervention required. Disabling Live Save puts DaVinci Resolve back into a state where you have to manually save by pressing Command-S (this can be useful when doing demos

when you don't want to save your changes to a project). Using Live Save is turned on by default and highly recommended to prevent the loss of work in the event you have a problem. It even works for previously unsaved projects that you've forgotten to save if anything goes wrong.

**NOTE:** When you use Collaborative Workflow to enable multiple artists to work together in the same project, Live Save is automatically turned on and cannot be disabled.

## Project Backups

Turning on the Project Backups checkbox in the Project Save and Load panel of the User Preferences enables DaVinci Resolve to save multiple backup project files at periodic intervals, using a method that's analogous to a GFS (grandfather father son) backup scheme. This can be done regardless of whether or not Live Save is turned on. Each project backup that's saved is a complete project file, excluding stills and LUTs, which are omitted in order to save storage space.

Once you've enabled Project Backups for a long enough time, whatever saved project backups have been created are retrievable in the Project Manager via the contextual menu that appears when you right-click a project, by choosing Project Backups to open the backups list dialog.

The backups list dialog shows you all backups that are available for a particular project, and has controls for sorting the list via different columns, deleting some or all of the backups in the list, and loading backups that you want to retrieve. Opening a project backup does not overwrite the original project; project backups are always opened as independent projects.

### To enable Project Backups:

- 1 Choose DaVinci Resolve > Preferences > User, and open the Project Save and Load panel.
- 2 Turn on the Project Backups checkbox.
- 3 Choose the settings that determine how many Project Backups will be maintained. Project Backups are saved on a first in, first out basis. Three fields let you specify how often to save new backups and how many backups to maintain, while the fourth lets you choose where the backups will be saved.

**Perform backups every X minutes:** The first field specifies how often to save a new backup within the last hour you've worked. By default, a new backup is saved every 10 minutes, resulting in six backups within the last hour. Once an hour of working has passed, an hourly backup is saved and the per-minute backups begin to be discarded on a "first in, first out" basis." By default, this means that you'll only ever have six backups at a time that represent the last hour's worth of work.

**Hourly backups for the past X hours:** The second field specifies how many hourly backups you want to save. By default, 8 hourly backups will be saved for the current day you're working, which assumes you're working an eight hour day (wouldn't that be nice). Past that number, hourly backups will begin to be discarded on a "first in, first out" basis.

**Daily backups for the past X days:** The third field specifies for how many days you want to save backups. The very last project backup saved on any given day is preserved as the daily backup for that day, and by default daily backups are only saved for five days (these are not necessarily consecutive if you take some days off from editing for part of the week). Past that number, daily backups will begin to be discarded on a "first in, first out" basis. If you're working on a project over a longer stretch of time, you can always raise this number.

**Project backup location:** Click the Browse button to choose a location for these project backups to be saved. By default they're saved to a "ProjectBackup" directory on your scratch disk, although you could change this to a volume that better fits into your data backup methodology.

- 4 Click Save to confirm your change, and then close the Preferences window.

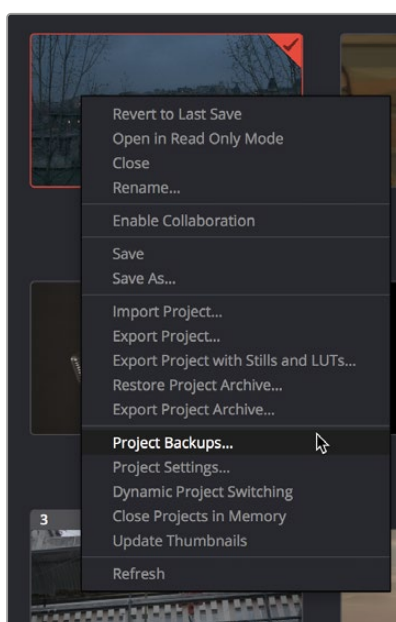


**NOTE:** When using this feature, the very first backup that's saved for a given day may be a bit slow, but all subsequent backups should be unnoticeable.

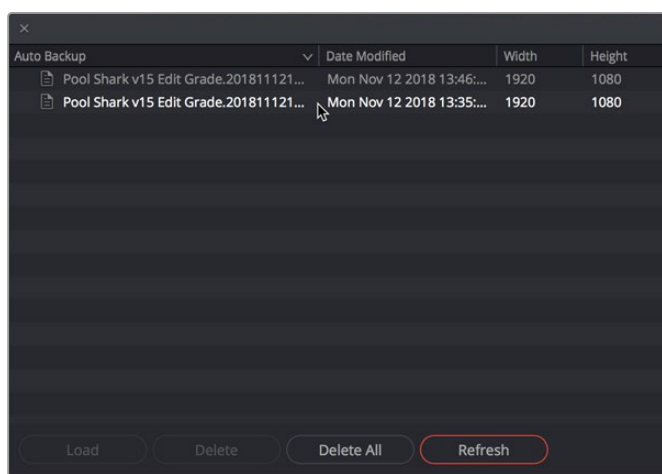
Once one or more Project Backups have been saved, you can access them in the Project Browser.

#### To open a Project Backup that's been saved:

- 1 Open the Project Manager.
- 2 Right-click a project, and choose Project Backups from the contextual menu.
- 3 Select a backup that you want to restore from the Auto Backups list. If you don't see the particular backup you want, you can click the Refresh button to update the list, or you can try sorting by one of the columns (Auto Backup, Date Modified, Width, Height) to better navigate the list.
- 4 Once you've selected the backup you want to restore, you can click Load to open that backup as a new project. If the project it was saved from is already open, it won't be overwritten.



Restoring a project backup in the Project Browser



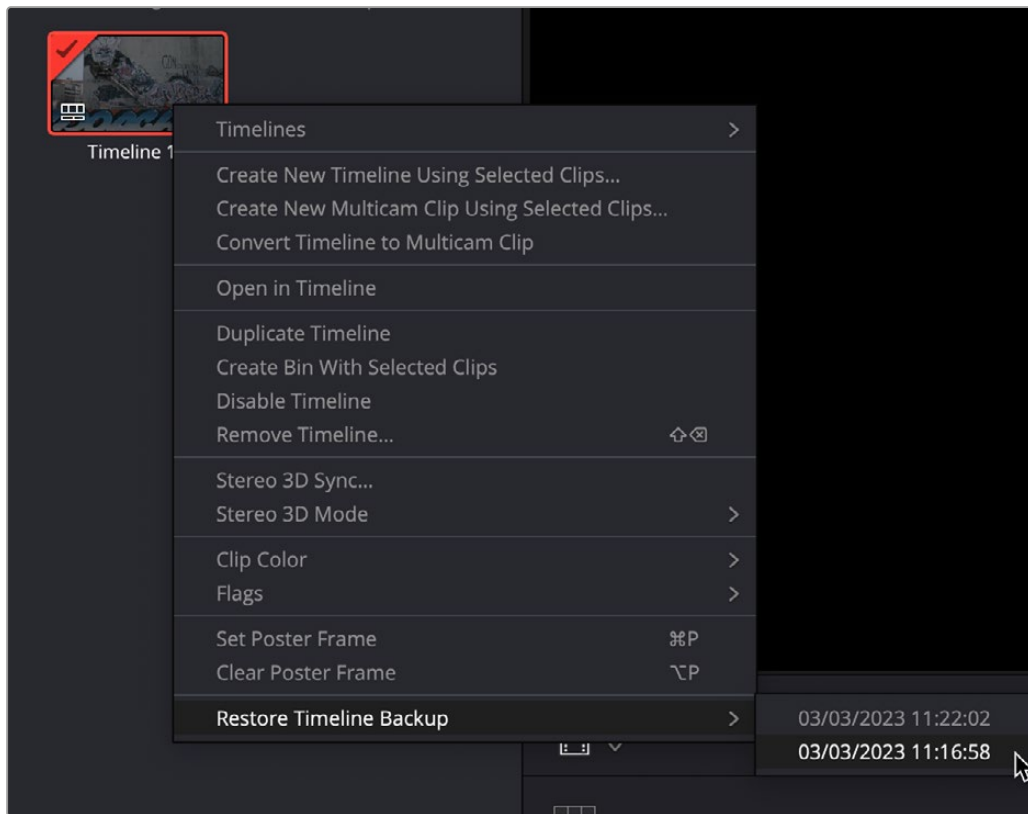
Selecting a backup that you want to restore

## Timeline Backups

Turning on the Timeline Backups checkbox in the Project Save and Load panel of the User Preferences enables DaVinci Resolve to save multiple backups of a timeline at periodic intervals, using a method that's analogous to a GFS (grandfather-father-son) backup scheme. This can be done regardless of whether or not Live Save is turned on.

If you want to revert to a previous backup of a timeline, simply right-click on the timeline in the Media Pool, select Restore Timeline Backup from the contextual menu, and choose the backup from the list of options. Backups are organized by date and time, making it easy to find the specific timeline you want to restore.

Restoring a timeline backup does not overwrite your current timeline. Instead the selected backup will be brought into the Media Pool as a new timeline, with the name “Backup” appended to it.



Restoring a timeline backup in the Media Pool

Timeline backups are only saved when changes have been made to a project. If DaVinci Resolve sits idle for any period of time, such as when your smart watch tells you to go outside and walk around the block, no additional project backups are saved, preventing DaVinci Resolve from overwriting useful backups with unnecessary ones.

Three fields let you specify how often to save a new backup, while the fourth lets you choose where the backups will be saved. These settings apply to both Project and Timeline backups.

- **Perform backups every X minutes:** The first field specifies how often to save a new backup within the last hour you've worked. By default, a new backup is saved every 10 minutes, resulting in six backups within the last hour. Once an hour of working has passed, an hourly backup is saved and the per-minute backups begin to be discarded on a first in, first out basis. By default, this means that you'll only ever have six backups at a time that represent the last hour's worth of work.
- **Hourly backups for the past X hours:** The second field specifies how many hourly project backups you want to save. By default, two hourly backups will be saved for the current day. Past that number, hourly backups will begin to be discarded on a first in, first out basis.
- **Daily backups for the past X days:** The third field specifies for how many days you want to save backups. The very last backup saved on any given day is preserved as the daily backup for that day, and by default daily backups are only saved for two days. Past that number, daily backups will begin to be discarded on a first in, first out basis. If you're working on a project over a longer stretch of time, you can always raise this number.
- **Project backup location:** Click the Browse button to choose a location for these backups to be saved. By default they're saved to a "ProjectBackup" directory on your scratch disk, although you could change this to a volume that better fits into your data backup methodology. This folder contains both Project and Timeline backups.

## Restoring Deleted Timeline Backups

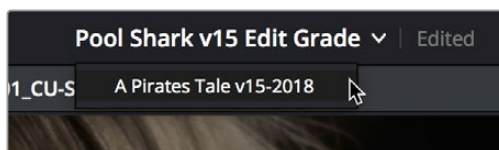
From the Media Pool Options menu, you can select Deleted Timeline Backups and examine deleted timelines and available backup files for each timeline. You can select backups to be restored or choose to permanently delete selected backups.

## Project Notes

Each DaVinci Resolve project now provides access to Project Notes, which is a simple “scratch pad” for keeping track of text notes associated with each project. These notes can be accessed using the File > Project Notes command, and there’s also a Project Notes command in the contextual menu for project icons in the Project Manager, which makes these notes accessible to everyone who’s connected to that project library.

## Dynamic Project Switching

Dynamic Project Switching is an option in the Project Manager contextual menu that lets you open multiple projects into RAM simultaneously, so you can quickly switch between projects when you want to copy and paste clips, timelines, and node settings back and forth. If you plan on opening many projects, or even just a few very large projects, you should be sure your workstation has an appropriate amount of RAM installed or you could experience a slowdown in performance.



Switching among open projects using the Project Title drop-down at the top of the DaVinci Resolve UI

### Methods of using Dynamic Project Switching:

- **To enable Dynamic Project Switching:** Open the Project Manager, right-click anywhere within the Project Manager and choose Dynamic Project Switching so that it’s checked. Dynamic Project Switching will remain enabled until you turn it off.
- **To open multiple projects in RAM:** Open any project, then reopen the Project Manager and open any other project. All projects you open are kept available in RAM.
- **To switch among open projects:** Choose File > Switch Project and select the project you want to switch to from the submenu. You can also choose other projects that have been opened into RAM from the drop-down menu that appears to the right of the project name at the top center of the DaVinci Resolve user interface.
- **To close a specific project:** Choose File > Close Project and select the project you want to close from the submenu. You may be prompted to save, after which the project closes.
- **To close all other open projects:** Open the Project Manager. All open projects appear with a check mark in the upper right-hand corner; the currently open project has an orange corner mark, while other projects open in memory have a gray corner mark. Right-click anywhere within the Project Manager, and choose Close Projects in Memory to close all projects other than the current one.

### Using dynamic project switching, you can do the following:

- Copy and paste clips from the Media Pool of one project into another.
- Copy and paste timelines from the Media Pool of one project into another. When you paste a timeline from another project, all of the clips used in that timeline will be pasted to the same location as well.
- Copy and paste clips from a timeline in one project to a timeline in another.
- Copy a node's settings from one project and paste them to a node in another project.

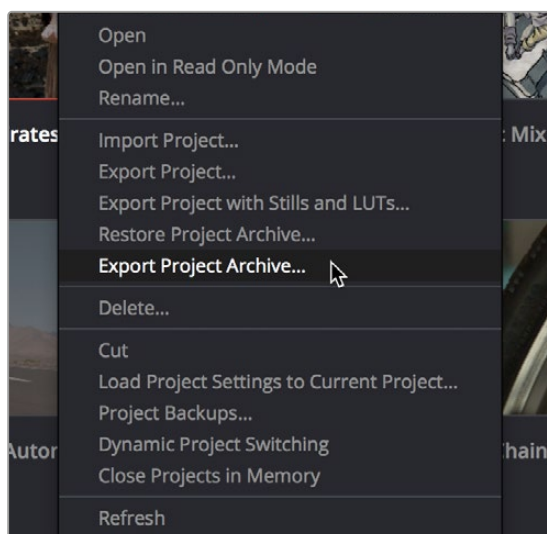
You can also copy and paste clips, timelines, and node settings from one project to another without using dynamic project switching, but using switching makes this process faster.

## Archiving and Restoring Projects

DaVinci Resolve has a convenient feature for quickly archiving every single media file used by a project, including subtitle files, along with the project itself, to a single location. This can be done to hand a project off to another DaVinci Resolve user, or to bundle a project and its media up for either short- or long-term archiving using the backup methodology of your choice. The process is simple.

### To Archive a project:

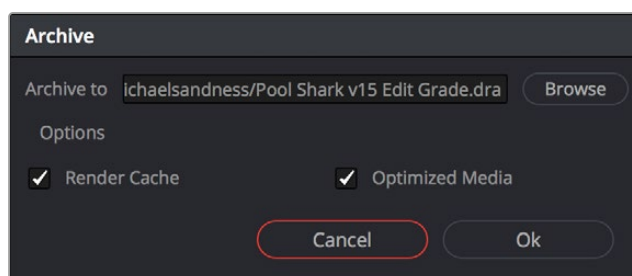
- 1 Open the Project Manager.
- 2 Locate and right-click the project you want to archive, and choose Archive.



The contextual menu command for archiving projects

- 3 When the Archive Project window appears, choose a location to save the archive. Make sure you choose a volume that's large enough to accommodate the size of all the media from the project you're archiving, and click Save.

- 4 When the Archive dialog appears, verify the location the archive will be saved to, and choose which optional media you want to save within the archive. You can optionally save Optimized media and/or Render Cache media associated with a project.



A dialog letting you choose whether to save Optimized and/or Render Cache media

- 5 Click Ok, and a dialog with a progress bar will show you how long the archive operation will take to finish. If any errors come up, resulting from missing or offline media, they'll be presented at the end of the process.

The resulting archive that is written is a directory with the .dra file extension. Inside this folder are a series of subdirectories containing all of the media that's used by the archived project. Each directory of media files used is saved within a directory path that mirrors the exact path it came from, so you have a reference for where each clip came from originally.

#### To restore an Archived project:

- 1 Copy the .dra archive directory you want to restore to the volume where you want those media files to be. Restoring doesn't move this directory, it only adds the project file within to the Project Manager, so you should make sure the .dra archive directory is located on a storage volume with suitable performance for you to work.
- 2 Open the Project Manager, right-click anywhere, and choose Restore from the contextual menu. Choose the .dra archive directory you just copied, and click Open.
- 3 At the prompt, enter a unique project name for the restored project, and click OK. The project is restored to the Project Manager, and remains linked to the media located inside the .dra archive.
- 4 Alternatively you can simply drag the .dra folder from your file system directly into the Project Manager.

If, after restoring an archive, you want to move its media to another location, you can use Media Management to do a move operation for all clips in that project. For more information on Media Management, see *Chapter 46, "Media Management."*